
PlanetScale for the database, and manual host payouts

Two items from the client on 18 September — whether PlanetScale is the right home for the MySQL database, and what the platform needs to pay hosts manually while no payout provider will take the company: what exists, what is missing, the changes, and the decisions.

Aajoo Homes — database and payouts

Prepared 18 September 2026 by the Zyphex Tech development team

Read from the live database and PlanetScale's published pricing on the same day

1. The two questions, and the short answers

Two items came from the client on 18 September:

1. *"For MySQL, check PlanetScale."*
2. *"For payouts, check the system for manual payouts."*

PlanetScale — yes, with three small adjustments. It is MySQL-compatible, has a Mumbai region and a Singapore region, and its smallest cluster is \$25 a month for a primary plus two replicas across three zones. Our database is small and plain MySQL, and moves in minutes. The one thing that matters more than the vendor is *which region*: the database must sit next to the API, not next to the users.

Manual payouts — the system is nearly ready for them. The queue, the ledger, the encrypted bank details, the audit trail and the host's payout history are all built. What is missing is a way to move the money without a payment provider: today "Approve" refuses because RazorpayX is not configured, and bank accounts cannot be verified because verification *is* RazorpayX. About two days of work closes that, and it is described in section 4.

2. What the database actually is — read from the live system on 18 September

Fact	Value	Why it matters
Engine	MySQL 8.0.43	Same major version everywhere we could move it
Tables	128, every one with a primary key	Every managed MySQL provider accepts this shape
Size	21 MB of data and indexes (43 MB on disk)	A move is a dump and a restore, minutes not hours
Foreign keys	39	The one PlanetScale setting to switch on (below)
Triggers, events, stored procedures	None	Nothing exotic to port
Where it lives today	Clever Cloud, Paris	Every request from India crosses to Europe and back

3. PlanetScale, checked on their site today

What it is. PlanetScale runs Vitess — MySQL with a layer on top that gives sharding, branching and zero-downtime schema changes. It is the database behind some very large products, and it is over-engineered for a 21 MB database; that is not a reason against it, as long as the price is right and the quirks are known.

Price and regions (planetscale.com/pricing, 18 September 2026). The smallest Vitess cluster, **PS-10** (1/8 vCPU, 1 GB memory, 10 GB storage, one primary and two replicas across three availability zones), came to **\$25 a month** in **AWS ap-south-1 (Mumbai)**; **ap-southeast-1 (Singapore)** is also offered. Backups are included. There is no free tier.

Three things to settle before saying yes — none of them large:

Point	What it means for us
Foreign key constraints are off on a new PlanetScale database	One checkbox in the database settings ("Allow foreign key constraints"); our 39 constraints then work as they do today.
<code>INSERT ... ON DUPLICATE KEY UPDATE</code> is refused on a table that has foreign keys	We use that statement in exactly one place (notification preferences). A ten-minute rewrite, done before the move.
"Safe migrations" blocks a direct <code>ALTER TABLE</code> on the main branch	Either switch it off on the main branch — reasonable at our size — or adopt PlanetScale's deploy-request flow. Our existing migration tool keeps working with it off.

Also true, and fine: connections must use TLS (a setting on our side); the primary is a small slice of a CPU, which is more than a 21 MB database with a few hundred users needs.

The region decision — read this before choosing Mumbai. A page on Aajoo runs five to ten database queries. If the API is in Singapore (Render's nearest region, see the hosting document) and the database in Mumbai, *each query* pays 40 ms across the sea — 200–400 ms a page, more than the 70 ms a user in India pays once to reach Singapore. **Put the database in the same region as the API.** If the API goes to Render Singapore, choose PlanetScale **Singapore**. If the platform later moves to AWS Mumbai, the database follows (a 21 MB database moves in an afternoon; PlanetScale offers Mumbai for that day).

Alternatives, for completeness:

Option	Region	\$/mo	Compatibility	Verdict
PlanetScale PS-10	Mumbai or Singapore	25	Three adjustments above	Recommended — HA at this price, the client's preference
DigitalOcean Managed MySQL	Bangalore	15 (single node) / ~30 with standby	Plain MySQL 8, zero changes	The zero-friction alternative; no Singapore region
Clever Cloud (today's vendor)	Singapore zone	~10	Zero changes	"Move nothing" option, not India
Aiven for MySQL	Mumbai	~70	Zero changes	Good product, three times the price
AWS RDS	Mumbai	~25–40	Zero changes	Blocked on the account's card verification

4. Manual payouts — what exists, what is missing, what changes

4.1 What the system has today (live numbers, 18 September)

- **A payout queue that fills itself.** Every paid booking queues the host's net share (room subtotal less 15% commission and the GST on it). Live: **18 payouts queued, ₹1,66,549 in total**; 4 marked failed, correctly, for cancelled stays.
- **Bank details, encrypted** (AES-256-GCM) with a single writer, masked in every screen.
- **A ledger, an audit trail** (every finance change needs a reason and is logged with who and when), **host statements and invoices**, and the pay-at-property offset — money a host owes the platform from a cash booking is withheld from their next payout automatically.
- **A host payout history** on the web and in the app.
- **RazorpayX integration**, complete and dormant: contact and fund-account registration, the ₹1 penny-drop verification, the transfer, the webhook. Blocked because the company is not eligible for RazorpayX (see the payout-rails document of 16 September).

4.2 Why nothing can be paid right now

- "Approve" on a queued payout **refuses** unless RazorpayX credentials are present — deliberately, because the earlier version marked payouts "paid" without any money moving.
- A host's bank account can only be **verified by RazorpayX's penny drop**. Live: **2 host accounts on file, 0 verified, 0 registered**. An unverified account is not payable, so every queued payout is stuck behind verification.

4.3 The changes

#	Change	Where
1	A payout mode switch — <code>manual</code> (default whenever RazorpayX is not configured) or <code>razorpayx</code> . Nothing is removed; the automatic path stays for the day the company qualifies for a provider	Backend
2	Verification without a provider — an admin with the finance role reveals the host's bank details (masked until revealed; every reveal audited), sends a ₹1 test transfer from the company account , and marks the account <i>Verified</i> with the bank reference. Replaces "not registered with the payment provider"	Backend, admin web
3	A payout run — the admin selects queued payouts, grouped one transfer per host (today's 18 rows are a handful of hosts), downloads a bank bulk-transfer file (beneficiary, account, IFSC, amount, narration), pays through the company's net banking, then records the run : UTR per host, method (NEFT / IMPS / UPI), date, amount sent. Recording marks the payouts complete, writes the ledger, applies the pay-at-property offset and notifies each host	Backend, admin web
4	The host sees the real thing — <i>Paid by bank transfer · 18 Sep · UTR ...</i> on the web and in the app, in place of a bare status	Host web, app
5	Guards — a UTR cannot be recorded twice; a payout on hold cannot be put in a run; two admins cannot pay the same host twice; every step carries a reason into the audit log	Backend

Effort: about two working days across backend, admin, host web and app, with tests. **What the company needs:** a bank account with bulk-transfer (NEFT/IMPS) on net banking, and a named person with the finance role who runs payouts on a fixed day each week.

4.4 One item for the company's accountant, not for us

As an e-commerce operator, Aajoo Homes most likely has to **deduct TDS under section 194-O** (0.1% of the gross amount) on host payouts and collect each host's PAN, with the usual threshold for individual hosts. The system can hold a TDS line per host and print it on the statement once the accountant confirms the rule and the rate. We would rather build that on an answer than on a guess.

5. Decisions needed

1. **PlanetScale — go ahead?** Recommended: yes. **Region:** the same as the API — Singapore if the API is on Render Singapore.
2. **Who owns the PlanetScale account** — recommended: the company, with the development team invited.
3. **Manual payouts — build as described in 4.3?** Three defaults unless told otherwise: one transfer per host per run; verification by a ₹1 test transfer; no TDS deduction until the accountant answers 4.4.

With those, the database moves in a day and manual payouts are live within the week.

PlanetScale prices and regions are as read on planetscale.com on 18 September 2026; DigitalOcean, Clever Cloud and Aiven figures are their list prices as of the same date — verify each on the provider's page before purchasing. Live database and payout figures were read from the production system on 18 September 2026.